FIGHTERBASE

Dairy-free

Diet guide

No milk, cheese, butter or yoghurt.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Dairy-free**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Dairy-free?

Leaves out milk and products made from it. For lactose intolerance, milk allergy or preference.

Where it comes from

Dairy-free eating is used for milk allergy, lactose intolerance, or personal choice. A true milk allergy is an immune reaction to milk protein. Lactose intolerance is a digestion problem with milk sugar, and many people can still handle small amounts or lactose-free milk.

The main ideas

1. Avoid milk and anything made from it: cheese, butter, cream, yoghurt, ice cream, whey, casein.
2. Replace dairy foods with fortified plant alternatives.
3. Read labels: milk hides in breads, sauces, chocolate, protein powders and processed meats.
4. Lactose-free dairy is not dairy-free: it still contains milk protein.
5. Allergy and intolerance are different: allergy needs strict avoidance and medical advice.

Who it suits

- People with milk allergy (with medical guidance)
- People with lactose intolerance
- People who feel better without dairy

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You think you have a milk allergy (get advice; reactions can be serious)
> - You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18
> - You are cutting out dairy for a baby or child

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Protein: meat, fish, eggs, tofu, beans, soy and pea protein powders.
- Calcium and vitamin D are the main concerns: choose fortified alternatives and add leafy greens, tinned fish with bones and almonds.
- Recovery drinks: soy milk or pea-based protein shakes work well, and lactose-free milk if your problem is lactose only.
- Check whey and casein in supplements, bars and shakes.

> Soy, pea or egg-based proteins instead of whey. Plant milk in oats.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Calcium
bones, especially in impact sport
Where: fortified plant milks and yoghurts, tofu set with calcium, sardines, kale, almonds

Vitamin D
bones and immunity
Where: oily fish, eggs, sunlight, supplement

Iodine
thyroid
Where: fish, iodised salt, fortified plant milk (not all are)

Protein
repair
Where: meat, fish, eggs, soy, beans

Common mistakes

- Not replacing calcium
- Choosing unfortified plant milks
- Missing hidden milk in labels
- Assuming 'non-dairy' means no milk protein: some 'non-dairy' creamers contain casein

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Milk is one of the allergens that must be highlighted in the ingredient list in the UK and EU
- Hidden milk: whey, casein, caseinate, lactose, milk solids, butter fat, ghee, lactalbumin
- Possible traces: 'may contain milk'

Eating out

- Tell staff clearly it is an allergy if it is one.
- Ask about butter on grills and in mash.
- Choose dishes cooked in oil rather than butter.
- Choose fruit or sorbet for dessert.

Easy swaps

Milk	→	Fortified soy, oat or almond drink
Butter	→	Olive oil or dairy-free spread
Cheese	→	Dairy-free cheese or nutritional yeast
Yoghurt	→	Soy or coconut yoghurt
Whey protein	→	Pea, soy or rice protein

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge with soy milk, banana	Chicken salad sandwich	Salmon, potatoes, broccoli
Tue	Eggs on toast	Tuna pasta	Beef stir-fry with noodles
Wed	Soy yoghurt, berries, granola	Lentil soup, bread	Chicken, rice, peppers
Thu	Cereal with fortified oat milk	Jacket potato with beans	Turkey burgers, wedges, salad
Fri	Omelette (cooked in oil)	Chicken wrap, hummus	Fish tacos, slaw
Sat	Pancakes (dairy-free), fruit	Leftover chilli	Chilli with rice
Sun	Full breakfast, no butter	Roast leftovers	Roast chicken, vegetables

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts · Hummus and vegetables · Soy yoghurt · Boiled eggs · Rice cakes with nut butter · Dark chocolate (check milk)

Shopping list

Fortified plant milk and yoghurt · Tofu set with calcium · Meat, fish, eggs · Beans, lentils · Leafy vegetables · Nuts · Olive oil, dairy-free spread

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is lactose-free the same as dairy-free?

No. Lactose-free milk still has milk protein.

Do I need a calcium supplement?

Many dairy-free eaters do not if they use fortified products. Ask a professional if unsure.

Can I have chocolate?

Dark chocolate often contains no milk, but may have traces. Check.

Further reading

NHS; Allergy UK; British Dietetic Association.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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